

VISUALIZATION PROCESS FOR GROWING INTO THE UNITIVE STATE

Greetings and blessings for all of you here, my dearest friends. This lecture is another step to help you in a very specific way -- a help that will now be increasingly more important and more necessary for many of you.

The individualized personality in the process of growth and expansion must always change into new states of consciousness and experience. Each stage widens and deepens in scope and makes new creative substance available with which to further create desirable life experiences and worlds. In this way, more of the abundance of the universe becomes available to the individual.

However, it is extremely difficult to visualize the new state to be grown or moved into unless an example of some sort exists. You all know that visualization is quite essential to the creating and recreating work you do in meditation. Unless you can visualize the state you are to grow into, it is hardly possible to reach it. Therefore, an example or a prototype provided by a figure who already has attained the desired state is essential if you are to print the proper concept onto your mind. As I mentioned many times, this "map," or "blueprint," is the first step. It is the idea that later materializes. Without the idea, materialization is completely impossible.

Attitudes, ways of being, patterns of behavior have a particular power to influence us. We might almost say they are contagious. This applies, of course, to both positive and negative attitudes and behavior patterns. Even feelings and the states they create can be contagious. It is known that some people's opinions can influence others enough to make them adopt the same opinions. This entire process of influence and contagiousness by "exemplary figures" leads to imitation, emulation, and identification. All of this can exist on a quite conscious, deliberate level or on very subtle, subliminal, involuntary levels.

It very much depends, of course, what figures are chosen to identify with, to emulate, to adopt from, to use as prototypes for a new state to grow into. The freer the soul; the less encumbered by distortions and misconceptions, by negativity and destructive impulses; the more reliable its choices become. This applies both to the conscious and unconscious choosing of the figure we want to identify with and also to the particular traits we pick to emulate or to discard. The ability to make such choices well depends on the purity of the state already attained by the chooser. So, as always, the beginning is the hardest. In this case, the person's own distortions may make him choose false heroes and at the same time make him utterly blind to the really desirable aspects of a possible exemplary figure. He does not see those aspects because the concepts are lacking. Only little by little in the process of development can he build the proper concepts so that he can subsequently recognize traits in exemplary figures that are to be used as further road maps, so to speak.

An individual personality chooses parents and environment on the basis of this principle as he journeys from one incarnation to the next. The proper exemplary figures setting off a spark of recognition in the concept of the seekers create a vibrant energy field whose creative power then molds the soul substance of those who have finally recognized the true examples. In the true and creative way this never means a false aping and a giving up of one's own uniqueness. Quite the contrary -- the traits, attitudes, and ways of being to be emulated are adapted to the uniqueness of the person who incorporates universal aspects into his own self-expression. He is totally true to himself when he emulates in a real and creative way. Only the false aping, the negative identification leads to self betrayal. Only negative attitudes in the self can lead to negative identification and choices of negative example figures.

Every parent is to his child a prototypical figure. Strong rejection of a parent or of particular traits and attitudes in the parent is an indication that a deliberate negative identification and aping took place, an aping against which the self now battles in a blind way because it has not recognized the real problem and is still groping in the dark.

To the degree that parent and child are healthy and purified souls, the child identifies with the positive aspects. The child will recognize what traits are to be used for his proto-plan and what traits are to be rejected in the parent (and later in other authority figures) only to the degree that he is receptive through his own power to know the truth.

Negative identification leads to the creation of images -- in the terms we use in this work. Images are always misconceptions, generalizations and form very limited and fixed closed systems. Identification (conscious and/or unconscious) that forms an inner image always creates a limited vision that precludes seeing available alternatives. This limitation can be called false vision. It is so exclusive of important factors, and the little that is seen is therefore so out of context that the perception of life and hence the reaction to it are unrealistic.

Positive identification can never lead to an image. It leads to visualization which is a flexible, realistic, wide-open system with many alternatives and many ways from which consciousness and creative action can spread in many directions.

It is very important for you to think about this and to really understand what I am saying here. On the spiritual path you come to a point when you must know that you need positive identification, that you need a realistic, open, freeing prototype. You need to recognize it, and if you cannot, you need to first build an inner concept so that you can visualize inwardly and outwardly (that is, recognize exemplary figures). Later you will become such exemplary figures yourselves so as to inspire others on their path when they are ready to see truth and to conceive of themselves according to their indwelling potentials. The true example inspires visualization of similar traits and attitudes dormant in the deeper self in order to bring them into full expression.

I mentioned before that the blocks and fogs created by illusion and distortion make you blind to true exemplary figures or to some of their traits. They cause you to be blind because your concept of what really exists in these examples is still absent. Such blocks can make you misconceive to such an extent that your interpretation of what you see may be completely wrong. Truthful perception of exemplary figures can only exist when you are already relatively free, open, and aware of yourself. When this is the case, suddenly something will click in you. A spontaneous,

almost automatic, organic desire will spring up in you to develop in the same direction. You will not imitate something that is foreign to your own nature. But basic universal traits exist and are expressed in different ways by different unique individualities. So you do not emulate to make an exact copy but to adapt the trait to your unique individuality. Somewhere along your path you will have gained sufficient self-awareness to have a subliminal understanding of what is worthy of emulation. You will be alert to it and use this vision to complete yourself.

As in every area of development, here, too, there are certain sequences and alternations according to spiritual law. Where the blocks exist and therefore proto-examples are absent and/or cannot be recognized, the psyche has to learn through the labor of the pathwork to choose realistic, positive figures as signposts. This requires to pay attention to this necessity and to conceive of inner visions of what the unified, harmonized, integrated person who expresses the contact and unification with the divine self is like. When such a concept exists, inner visualization can begin, which in turn will make you capable of meeting and recognizing the outer figure who can further help, affect, and inspire you by the process of contagiousness to become fully your best self.

In this lecture, I wish to give you some clear-cut pointers and initial concepts of what to look for, what to be attuned to, and what to be prepared for as your own as yet dormant potentiality. I will draw a picture, so to speak, what it is like, inwardly as well as outwardly, to come to the point where the personality truly unites with the inner self, with the inner reality, with the divine self, with the inexhaustible wealth that is every human being's inner nucleus -- the center of his very being. I wish to discuss certain aspects of this, for it is, of course, quite impossible to cover such an immense topic in merely one lecture. So this is just an outline, a sketch that describes certain very basic conditions and expressions which can safely be generalized and applied to everyone who has reached the state in which the divine self is actualized as a continuous process and life-expression. I will try to give you a concept and a vision with which you can begin to see afresh -- to look around you and perhaps recognize in others what you had previously been blind to.

When the individual comes to the state where he chooses to deliberately, consciously, and intentionally commit himself to the divine will and reality, then the groundwork has been laid for certain vital changes to occur in the inner and outer life. This is a commitment to the All-Consciousness, indwelling in every creature, that can be called by any name you choose -- God, universal consciousness, the real self, the inner self -- whatever the name, it does not matter. But it transcends the little ego. When this commitment is being made wholly and totally in all ways, then certain things begin to happen in the person's life. Obviously, one reaches this state not by crossing a sharply defined line. Reaching it is a gradual process which I will describe here. But before doing so, I wish to say that you must not be misled by the fact that you may consciously have made such a commitment, and yet no great inner or outer change has occurred. I speak here particularly to those of my friends who are relatively new in this work. Some of you may be very committed to God on a conscious level, but you may not at all realize that there are other levels in you where this is not the case. It may be very easy to believe that this commitment is what you want on a merely conscious level. There you may be full of good will and really mean it. But unless you have gotten in touch with the contradictory levels where you do not wish that commitment, where instead you only wish it on your ego-terms (which defeats the very act of self-surrender, of course) which may not be the terms of the All-Consciousness; then you want to balk. Unless you acknowledge this level of your contrariness, fear, self-will, and pride, your conscious commitment will always be blocked and never quite "take." Unless you own up to the contrary ego-level hidden behind the good will, you may not

even understand why certain results are still lacking in spite of your conscious commitment to truth, to God, to love. This aspect is extremely important and this path deals with it, as you all know, in a very intensive way. In that way, one of the most insidious obstructions is avoided: self-deception. We search for and bring out that part of the negative self which says "I will not." You all learn the courage, humility, and honesty to expose this part -- the part that even says, "I want to resist. I want to spite. I want to have it all my way, or else!" Only when the secret crevices of your psychic substance yield up, reveal, and expose these areas, can you begin -- not easily, often with a lot of struggle -- to change this very negative level, this darker part of the personality. When this part remains hidden, you are split and do not understand why your positive endeavors fail to go further than they do.

Then there comes a point when you have won this particular battle. At this stage you can wholeheartedly embrace and trust the surrender to the divine consciousness. But, again, this does not come in one swoop. At first this surrender must be fought for every time. You need self-discipline to remind yourself. Although resistance is gone, the outer self is still conditioned to the old functioning and automatically forges ahead on the top level of the mind. At this stage you need to acquire a new habit pattern. It takes time. Perhaps when you are really in trouble, in a state of crisis, you will remember to let go and let God. But in ordinary life, in your everyday chores, this does not occur to you yet. Perhaps you can do it where you are relatively free but still find the old obstinacy, distrust, and forgetfulness where the problems persist. Only little by little do you reach the state where the new habit pattern is instituted and in which the act of self-surrender to the All is actualized and manifest; where it permeates all your thoughts and perceptions, your decisions and actions, your feelings and reactions. We shall come back to this.

First let me speak about the relationship between the inner and the outer life. A lot of confusion exists among mankind about this topic. There are those who claim only the inner is important. They prohibit the inevitable movement from the inner to the outer because of the limitation, the actual falsity of this idea. If the unification and the divine process are truly in movement, the inner content must express itself in outer form. In short, the outer life must mirror the inner life in every possible respect. But if your consciousness ignores this truth or even strongly embraces the opposite belief (namely that the outer does not matter), then you prohibit the flow and the movement of the whole process. Thus the more radiant energetic matter cannot express itself on the levels of coarser matter, thereby refining the latter. You may recall that in one of the more recent lectures I described how creation attempts to fill the void. Every human being helps in this task and thus refines the coarser matter by bringing the inner spiritual reality into outer expression.

The false concept, that the outer does not matter, encases the inner spiritual truth and beauty behind a wall that separates the spiritual reality from the material reality, and the individual with this false concept begins to see a dichotomy between the "two" which are really one. Many movements and spiritual schools of thought preach asceticism and the denial of the outer life -- all under the guise that this furthers the inner spiritual life. This distortion is a reaction to an equal distortion representing the opposite extreme.

This opposite false extreme is the position that the outer form is more important than inner content, which may manifest in negating that there is an inner reality or content and in asserting that all that matters is the outer form. True inner growth must eventually also manifest outwardly (although not necessarily with the speed designated by the outer-oriented person who is thus making

mistakes in judgment). But it is certainly possible to express outer form without it being a direct expression of inner content. You must therefore be careful in your evaluations.

These two distortions are faulty counter-reactions to each other, one attempting to eliminate the other by its own misunderstanding. This is a phenomenon that occurs on all subjects, topics, and ideas as long as man's consciousness is entrapped in the dualistic illusion. I spoke about this principle in connection with many other topics and apply it now to this one. In different eras, civilizations, and cultural conditions, one of the two different, opposite distortions may be adopted -- until the pendulum swings to the other. Only the truly connected, actualizing, unified person expresses outer form as an inevitable sequence of inner content.

When the outer form exists without the inner content, it is a temporary cover that must break down even though it resembles the glorious perfection of divine reality and its expressions. Again, this is a process that repeats itself in many areas along the curve of development. It is an ongoing law that all false covers must crack and crumble. When the outer form exists unconnected with an organic inner content, it must crash. If it exists on faulty premises -- premises based on appearance, on confusing the outer life with the inner -- then it must first go before it can be rebuilt as an organic expression of the inner movement and content. Only when the outer form is crashed and the inner chaos exposed and eliminated in a profound way, can the inner beauty build outer beauty; the inner harmony build the outer one; the inner abundance build outer abundance as well. A clear vision of this principle is also necessary for creating visualization of your own movement and the manifestations in your outer life as a result of the inner process.

I shall now discuss specific aspects and manifestations that take place with the person who is already deeply anchored in the process of actualizing the divine life into his ego consciousness. What are the inner and outer attitudes, manifestations, and expressions of such a person inwardly and outwardly? All decisions big or small are made on the basis of the aforementioned self-surrender. The little self surrenders to the Godself. The little self steps aside and allows the inner wisdom to permeate it. All matters are included into this process because the personality realizes by now that there is nothing that is not important. Every thought, every opinion, every interpretation, every mode of reacting is given a chance to be permeated by the greater consciousness. At this stage the resistance to do so is overcome. The new habit has been formed so that the divine process is now self-perpetuating. It is so much a part of the whole person that it is operative even on those rare occasions when the personality forgets to establish the contact, when perhaps an old raw area still flares up and pushes the personality in the wrong direction. The inner self is sufficiently freed to manifest so that it can send forth warning, disagreement, advice and then leave the decision of whether or not to follow such advice to the outer personality. This is already a state of grace. Confidence and trust have been established as a result of repeated proof that the divine reality brings veracity, wisdom, goodness, and joy. At first, the divine will is not trusted. It is confused with untrustworthy parental authority which may often have proclaimed something as "good" for the child that really proved not to be so. But at the stage in question, this confusion no longer exists. The self is fully aware that the divine will is truly in accordance with what the heart may possibly desire. This trust grows gradually with every time you overcome resistance and go into the apparent abyss of surrender where the little self-will is given up.

This self-perpetuating divine process brings such a vital, revolutionary change into the entire person that I can touch upon only a few of its manifestations. Thoughts of truth will be sent forth

into your being, notwithstanding the limited thoughts you still habitually follow. You will hear an inner voice instructing you with a wisdom and unifying spirit that the outer self is incapable of. According to this wisdom, there is never any need to hate, to feel self-rejecting, to reject others. These answers and revelations show the oneness and unity of all, which completely eliminates fear, anxiety, friction, and despair. The attitude of giving up the limited ego knowledge to the knowledge of the deeper self; to exert all energy, investment, courage, honesty, and self-discipline to make such deeper knowledge a self-perpetuating phenomenon is the fulfillment of all else. It is the foundation without which no joy, no pleasure, no fulfillment can exist for long. And while it does, it becomes unbearable. It cannot be accepted. Give up the stake in the negative reaction; in the opinionatedness of the little mind; in the laziness that forces you to succumb to the old habit of the separated self. You thus gain the true life. Wait patiently, but be ready to receive the divine wisdom you can activate if you so desire.

When this state has been instituted or is in the process of being continually deepened and strengthened, then certain other manifestations begin to appear inwardly and outwardly. I will touch upon a few, and in the future I will mention more. Some of them you will discover by yourself.

You will find an immense security. This security that you can only gain when you discover the reality of the spiritual world within you and operative around you. You will then know the deep peace of the meaning of your life -- of all life. You will intuitively know the connections and be permeated by a sense of fulfillment and safety that surpasses all words. All this is then no longer a theory or belief that you cling to or deny -- whichever the case may be. But it is an experiential fact which you can see again and again. There is always a way out of every darkness and therefore never a reason to despair. You will know that nothing happens without cause -- and good cause -- and that you are always capable of using whatever you experience to heighten your blissful life. Dark spots become opportunities for further light and no longer need to be avoided whether they be pain, guilt, fear, or whatever. Again and again you experience the wide open system of creation.

You will know and make use of your own creative powers rather than feeling a helpless object in a fixed world. Peace and knowledge of the rightness of life come from realizing that your world, your experience, your life is your creation. This opens many new doors. You no longer live in the two-dimensional world of either/or. You avail yourself of the many faceted reality at your disposal.

The confidence and fearlessness in which you then live perforce release an immense amount of energy and joy. As you lose your fear of pain because you can experience pain, pain ceases to exist. As you lose your fear of anger and hate because you can accept your own anger and hate, they no longer exist. The energy is now free for other, better expressions. You now become capable of pleasure and joy and no longer need to reject them. Instead of creating loneliness, you can create relationships -- the bliss of the most intimate one with one mate and the satisfaction of deep, open friendships. Pleasure no longer frightens you because you now know in every pore and cell of your being that you deserve it. Every pore and every cell are consciousness now in harmony with your God consciousness.

Many of you find yourself in an interim state in which you experience new joys and pleasures which you never knew existed. Life opens up for you as it never did. But you also find yourself in the position where as yet you cannot bear too much of it. This is because you have not made the surrender to the God consciousness total. Or you have not sufficiently faced negative aspects in you

and still cling to them. So you fear the pleasure which becomes more frightening than the greyness you wish and create, a greyness of neither pleasure nor pain. You often want to painstakingly preserve this state of greyness without knowing that you do so. It is a greyness that gives you comfort, but in the long run it leaves you empty.

An inevitable manifestation in the inner life of the continuous process of actualizing the deep self is the incredible creativity that blossoms out of you. You are then creative in ideas, alternatives, talents, richness of feelings, ability to live with and relate to others. You find the treasure of your creative powers, the wealth of your feelings, the fullness of your own being! Only as you go through the emptiness, can you find that fullness. And that requires the courage which comes when you pray or meditate for it. You must want it and commit yourself to it.

This fullness of feelings, this wealth of creative ideas, and the ability to live in the now, in its excitement and peace (not mutually exclusive opposites, but facets of the same fullness) will spread deeper and wider. The times when you lose it will come less often and be less severe.

Since you now have the power to create, you can create a deeper intuitive understanding about yourself, others, and life. Your total relaxedness about every part of yourself, which eliminates the need to cover up and escape from anything in you, must make you aware of other people on their deepest levels. You read their thoughts and understand the deeper connections within and between them so that you can help, have empathy, can love them, and never, never need to fear and defend against them with destructive ego defenses.

The outer manifestations must follow suit. Health will be glowing. You will have vitality and energy as you never had before. You will be in vibrant, glowing health. The energy that you expend will always be replenished -- and more so. All your functions will be in perfect working order. All your physical systems will be coordinated. This will affect your outer looks. You cannot help being beautiful when you are in such vibrant health and harmony. It will show in the grace and poise of your movements, the balance and coordination you express, in the tone of your voice, in the sparkle of your eyes, in the brilliance of your skin, in the suppleness of your form. The improvement will come in varying degrees. It is always possible. Think of this as your possibility. You will be able to materialize it because you already are essentially that person. But you cannot materialize it if you either have a stake in believing you cannot be that person or if you want all that vitality, health, radiance, and beauty for the sake of egotistical reasons or for the sake of competitive power drives. Then the inner guilt will not let you have it. There are of course those who have it only as an outer expression. In that case, the time comes when it must break down before it can be rebuilt as a result of a connection with inner content.

There is an innate system of divine justice built into the consciousness. Whenever a life expression is sought that does not come as a harmonious outer result of an inner reality, it will either not succeed or will break down after it has been created. The real inner guilt that psychologists all chalk up to "neurotic" guilt operates here. However, such guilt is indeed neurotic when it expresses itself in distorted perfectionism which hides the unwillingness to give up a real guilt. So when you find resistance to happiness, look at the meaning and at the areas of justified guilt.

The inner unity with your eternal self makes it possible to use your creative ability to explore any area of universal truth you truly wish to comprehend. You now know the power of thought and

consciousness and you can focus it as a result of the self-discipline you have learned. Thus you can create a creative receptivity in regard to experiencing the eternal state beyond physical "death." This perception is not reliable as long as you seek it out of your fear of death. It is reliable only when you do not fear death because you now can die just as you can now be in pain. Whenever you want something because you fear its opposite, the results cannot be reliable. You can create only out of fullness, not out of need and poverty. So the difficulty is the initial creation of fullness. Seeking the opposite of what you fear is an escape and leads to a split rather than unification. Exactly the opposite road must be taken. You must die many deaths right now, every day in your life in order to discover the eternity of life. Only then will you live fearlessly.

How can you die all these little deaths? Exactly by the process I described, by letting go of the little ego, the little opinions, the negative reactions you have such an investment in. You have to die to that. The little ego with its little investments must die. In that way you can transcend death and intuitively experience the reality of life that is ongoing.

When you live without fear of death because you experience it so many times, you will know that the principle of physical death is the same. You find it to be by temporarily letting go of the smaller self only in order to find a larger self awakening which then unifies with the little self. So you see, not even the little self of the ego really dies. It is enlarged and united with the larger self, not given up. But it appears to be given up, and you must be ready to take the plunge.

When this happens, a measure of eternity will manifest in your life right now. It manifests not only by eliminating fear of dying but also in a more practical, immediate sense. It will keep you in a vitality and youthfulness that is a foretaste of the timelessness and agelessness of the real life.

Another outward manifestation is abundance. Since the real spiritual life is limitless abundance, to some degree you must begin to manifest that when you actualize the divine self. If you can make room in your consciousness for the outer abundance as a reflection of the universal abundance, you will create and experience it. But again, if you want to experience it because you fear poverty, you also create a split. The abundance you then create is not built on reality and is thus a flimsy structure that must be crushed again so that you can then let yourself be poor and dissolve the illusion of poverty. Then the real, unified richness can grow. Only when you can be poor, can you allow yourself to be rich as an outer expression of inner content. Then you will not want to be rich for the sake of power, of outer gains in the eyes of others, of greed and fear, but as a true divine expression of that abundance that is the nature of the universe.

Another outer manifestation of the continual process of actualizing divine life is the proper balance of everything. The balance of assertion and giving in, for instance. The spontaneous knowledge to know when one or the other is appropriate comes from within. Or take for instance the proper balance of right selflessness and right selfishness as opposed to wrong selflessness and wrong selfishness. All these balances, all these dualities will become elements in a spontaneous unification and harmony. The intuitive knowledge of when, what, and how will come not because you decide it with your mind but as an expression of the inner truth and beauty that reaches the outer levels appropriately and beautifully.

There will be a poise and a beauty in your whole bearing and a courtesy and a chivalry that never needs to fear to be ridiculous and to be taken advantage of. There will be order without a

trace of compulsiveness -- order in all things of your life. Order and beauty are related and interdependent. There will be generosity and a giving and receiving in one ongoing stream. There will come a deep ability to be grateful and to appreciate others, yourself, the whole creative universe.

There is a new freedom to be soft and vulnerable which makes you truly strong, without false shame, as there is the new freedom to be strong and assertive -- even angry -- without false guilt. You will know and act from within because you are in constant contact with the wisdom, love, and truth of your inner divine reality.

The emotional loneliness that is the self-chosen lot of so many people gradually begins to disappear among my friends. In your development you learn to be real, to function without your masks and pretenses. Consequently you begin to feel comfortable in closer intimacy. As you simultaneously cease to fear the pain/pleasure syndrome, true ecstasy and deep fusion on all levels must give you the deepest fulfillment a human being can experience. This will progress to new heights and depths of experience where you explore the inner universe in unison. Loneliness and the torture of conflict about the need for and fear of closeness will no longer exist. Such relationships fuse on all levels, as I said many times before.

Abundance of the universe expresses itself in all areas of life. In the sharing, the respect, the warmth, the ease and the comfort with which you can be intimate and fused with another person, give to and receive from another person. The security of your own feelings will make you equally secure about being loved. You will experience the deep satisfaction of giving, helping, fulfilling a task, of being devoted to doing so. You will rejoice in the ongoing creative process that is at work in it.

All of these are gauges for you, my friends. These gauges are not to be used to put yourself down in impatience and intolerance. They are gauges you can use in order to create a deliberate inner visualization about any and all of these life expressions. And then you will perhaps be more strongly motivated to search further for what still stands in the way. This lecture will give you many tools and a lot of material for your work.

The love of the universe spreads over all of you and reaches deep into your hearts, my dearest friends. Be blessed, be God.

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